Bico Steve

Backend Developer | Java, Python | Spring Boot, FastAPI | Kafka | REST APIs, Distributed Systems

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SUMMARY

Backend developer with a quality-engineering edge: 3+ years in test automation and a year of part-time backend work building Python APIs for fintech and betting platforms. Built and deployed an event-driven Java system (Spring Boot, Kafka, RabbitMQ) with 470+ unit tests and CI/CD to AWS, and built KYC, authentication and M-Pesa payment APIs.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, SQL, JavaScript
Backend: Spring Boot, FastAPI, Flask, REST APIs, microservices, event-driven architecture, object-oriented programming, Maven
Data and messaging: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ
Testing and CI/CD: JUnit, Pytest, Playwright, Testcontainers, GitHub Actions, Docker, AWS, Git
Practices: Agile/Scrum, API and regression test automation, debugging distributed systems, AI-assisted development .

SELECTED PROJECTS

Bixx Sportsbook: free-to-play sportsbook platform (personal project)
Live: sportbook.bixx.co.ke | *Code:* github.com/bicosteve *(rapid_engine, event-consumer, api-gateway)*

- Designed and built a three-service, event-driven Java 21 backend (ingestion producer, event consumer, API gateway) on Spring Boot, with a selectable RabbitMQ or Kafka broker, Redis delta cursors, idempotent message processing and an auditable transaction trail.
- Wrote 470+ unit tests plus Testcontainers integration tests; automated build and deployment to AWS with GitHub Actions CI/CD and Docker.
- Deployed to AWS with a web UI; 10 active users.

Python REST APIs (personal): Flask job-board-api and FastAPI inizio-media

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer in Test Mar 2023 – Present
Betika.com, Remote

- Engineered Playwright API and UI test automation inside GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines, raising regression coverage by 95% and cutting manual test execution by 90%.
- Collaborated with developers and DevOps to debug and troubleshoot distributed-service failures using logs, request payloads and message queues, reducing diagnosis time to 20 minutes.
- Built automated daily health-check tests for key system functions, so issues surface in the pipeline within 20 minutes.
- Reviewed requirements, user stories, specifications, and technical designs and gave early feedback to the Agile/Scrum team, so ambiguities were resolved before development began.
- Performed API testing of GraphQL and backend services, validating results with SQL queries against PostgreSQL.

Backend Software Developer (Part-time) Jun 2025 – May 2026
Avela Technologies, Nairobi

- Developed Python REST APIs for user and company onboarding, registration and verification workflows; onboarded 30 users with a 90% KYC form acceptance rate.
- Implemented KYC identity verification and secure authentication (registration, login, password reset) that met compliance requirements in a high-security environment.
- Built live payment APIs integrating M-Pesa and bank deduction for an Earned Wage Access platform, handling transactional workflows where correctness and reliability matter.
- Deployed services to AWS and worked with GitHub Actions CI/CD.

EDUCATION

Master of Information Technology in English (MIT-EN), in progress 2026 – Present
Brno University of Technology, Faculty of Information Technology (FIT BUT)

MSc, Information Systems & Computing 2023 – 2025
Strathmore University

Bachelor's degree, Communication 2011 – 2014
Moi University

CERTIFICATIONS AND LANGUAGES

Certifications: ISTQB-CTFL **| Languages:** English (Full professional), Czech (Elementary)